

Aki Fukai

Elbchaussee 15
22765 Hamburg, Germany
USt-IdNr. DE229552221

+49 172 431 15 00
aki@fukai.ch
<https://fukai.ch>

Principal Product Designer
0→1 Products & Enterprise SaaS

I'm curious to learn about your strategic objectives and biggest challenges.

Let's talk and see how starting with your users can help to solve existing problems or uncover new opportunities.



I'm attracted to complex problems and love finding future-orientend solutions. I believe that the best solutions begin with deeply understood user struggles and desires. I also believe they live at the intersection of user needs, long-term business success, and social and planetary responsibility.

I have over 20 years of hands-on product design leadership experience. Companies I've worked with: collect.AI (Otto Group), enfore AG, frog design (Siemens), Henkel, JobRad, Mercedes-Benz, SAP, Swiss Federal Railways (SBB), Telefónica Germany (o2)



JOBRAD



collect.AI

otto group



frog

UNIFY

razorfish.



Helping local stores to run their business – with enforePOS.

Led key UX & UI design initiatives for the retail and hospitality POS and ERP platform serving SMEs through Deutsche Telekom, Swisscom et al.

Designed complex B2B2C journeys across a multi-device landscape

End-2-end discovery and delivery of:

- **Reservations** at POS and online
- **Pick-up & delivery** at POS and online
- Data driven **dashboard KPI widgets**
- Continues improvement of **enforePOS**
- Designed and shipped **Online Presence**
- Dynamic **email & business docs**
- Extension of the **design system** across proprietary mobile, tablet, desktop devices, web and email

Role: Senior Product Designer

Duration: 2 years, started at precious design studio.

Technology: enforePOS software, React, Foundation 4 Emails
Contract extended to perm. employment after 8 months



Receivables redefined, customer centric & data informed – collectAI.

Led the UX & UI for the as the founding product designer simplifying debt-resolution end-to-end, with AI-driven, adaptive payment journeys (Otto Group Startup).

Designed and helped shipping from scratch

- Next generation **claim management platform**
- Mobile first modular end customer facing **white label payment journeys**
- Established **design system/ops** as a team of one
- **Hackathon** (AI-powered financial forecast tool)

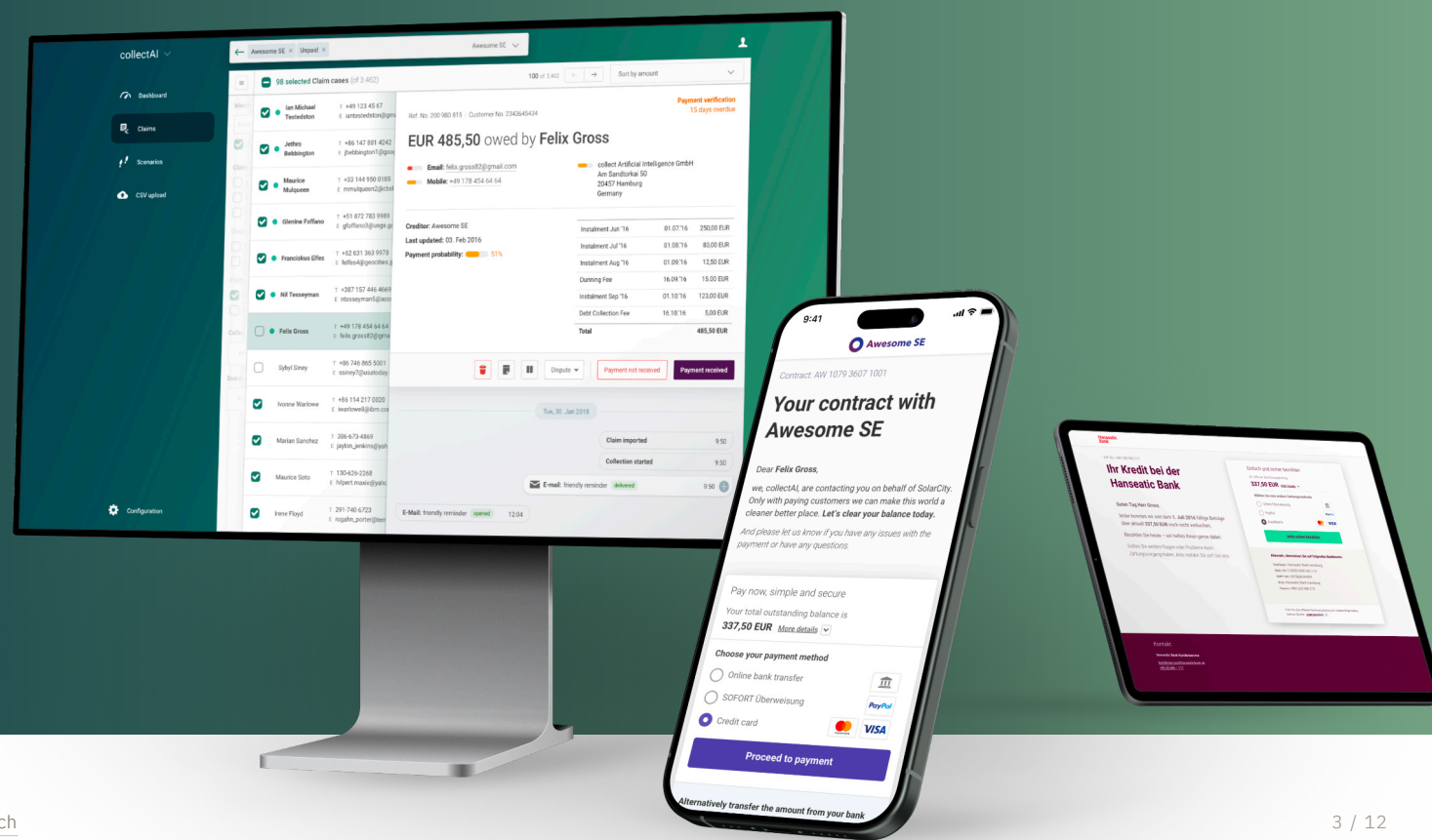
Results

- Crafted the product design that scaled receivables management to **€25M in 18 months**
- Increased **realization rate by 33%**
- Processing **cost reduction by >30%**
- Helped ship **regulatory compliant** receivables management workflows and payment flows **within strict financial and GDPR rules**

Role: Founding Senior Interaction Designer

Duration: 2 years, from inception at Liquid Labs (Otto Group) to scale; Contract extended to perm. employment after 7 months

Technology: mobile first responsive web/email, React



PlasticPlan: Making Plastic packaging sustainable, AI-powered, zero to one.

Worked as Lead Product Designer with CPO and Tech Lead to build a high-volume AI-driven enterprise data processing platform (Henkel Venture).

Improved product delivery speed and quality

- Resulting in faster time-to-market and successful deployment of 12+ product initiatives.
- By introducing Shape-Up, aligning cross-functional stakeholders, and mentoring design talent.

Enterprise Impact and Validation

- Secured LoI from Landbell, Bahlsen, and Melitta
- UX/UI design enabled up to 80% AI-driven reduction in plastic tax reporting costs
- Data Scale: 236M+ data points processed, 800K+ packaging comp., 160K+ products classified

Role: Principal Product Designer

Duration: 6 months contract, from zero to ready to scale

Technology: Web, Vue.js, Tailwind

Impact: SDG 12 (responsible consumption and production), SDG 13 (climate action), (SDG 14, 9)

Established scalable multilingual design infrastructure

- Facilitating a smooth rollout in multiple locales.
- By building a complex responsive design system in collab with the FE lead and integrating Lokalise.

Shipped product capabilities in a nutshell

Collect, evaluate and visualize packaging data and its impact on the environment with built-in collaboration.



Hello Meet: Finding time together made simple. Finally.

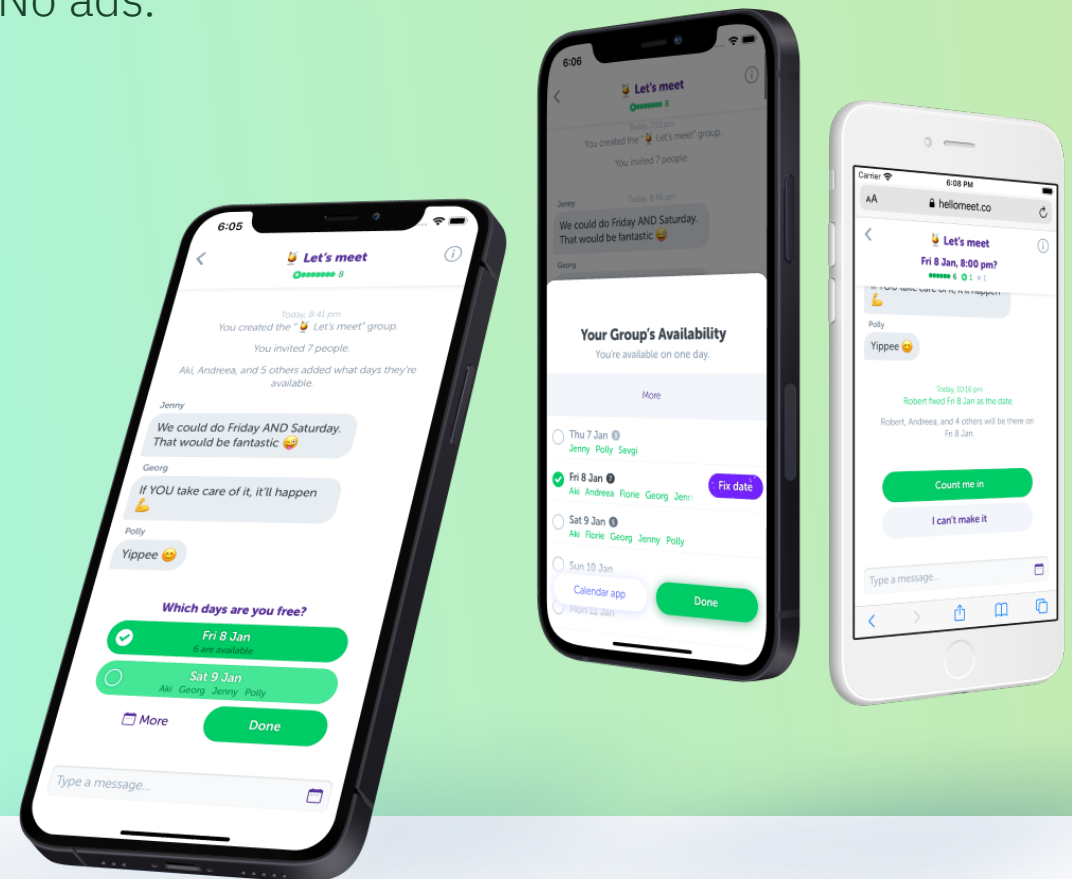
Co-founded a social group appointments making super simple for everyone. Privacy first. Customer-to-business. No ads.

- Established hypothesis driven product design and developments
- Introduced JTBD based user flows and UIs
- **Shipped multiple iterations** based on qualitative insights
- Developed and tested **new feature discovery**, testing and development
- Drove Continuous improvements and **UI component library**
- Continuous **sensing and responding**
- Co-shaping and testing the **C2B business model**

Role: Co-Founder & Founding Product Designer

Duration: ~2 years (net), started as a side project, evolved into full time*

Technology: iOS, Android, Web, React



whatever.works: Freedom to work from anywhere, legally compliant.

Scaled the JobRad-backed HR Tech SaaS from zero to MVP to 30+ enterprise clients in under a year, rebranding it while locking in product-market fit.

Turned a chaotic initiative into an award-winning compliance platform for remote work

Led product design hands-on in tandem with interim CPO and Tech Lead

- **MVP launch in 70 days**, scaling to 30+ enterprise clients and coverage of 150+ countries.
- **Introduced Shape-Up** for continuous discovery for **faster and higher quality delivery**.
- Fostered **alignment with key stakeholders**
- **Hired and mentored** fresh design talent.

Established scalable multilingual design infrastructure

- Resulting in a **smooth rollout of compliant customer journeys** across geographies.
- By building a custom **responsive design system** and **integrating Lokalise**, aligned with HR workflows.

Recognized as Best HR Startup 2023

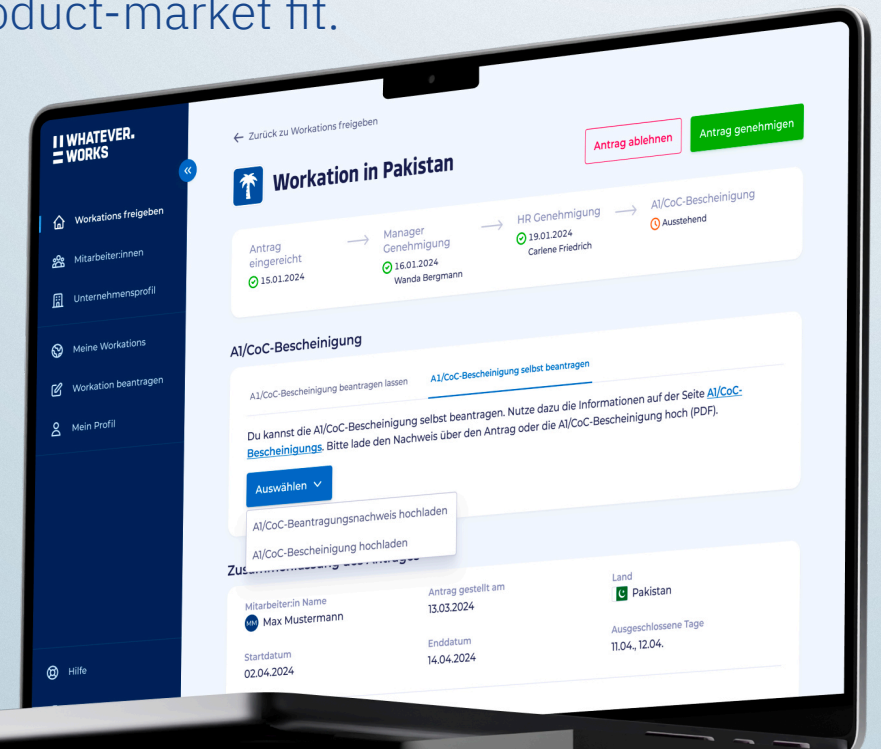
- Through combining product delivery excellence with **user-centric compliance flows**.

Role: Principal Product Designer → Design Director

Duration: 14 months contract, from zero to one

Technology: Web, React, Material UI

Impact: SDG 8 (decent work and economic growth)



Unify Project Ansible.

Business is about relationships. And relationships start with a conversation.

Together with frog and Unify I had the honor to envision and define the user experience throughout web and mobile from overarching concepts to detailed features, interactions and UI.

Technology: iOS, Android, Web, WebRTC

Role: Senior Interaction Designer

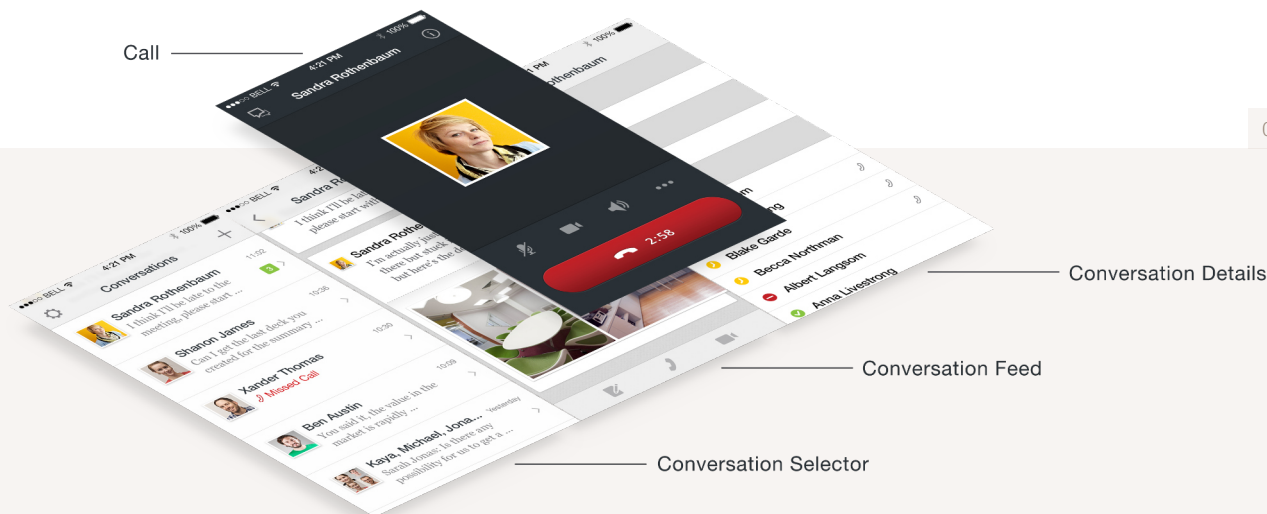
Duration: 5 months contract



01

Unify Project Ansible.

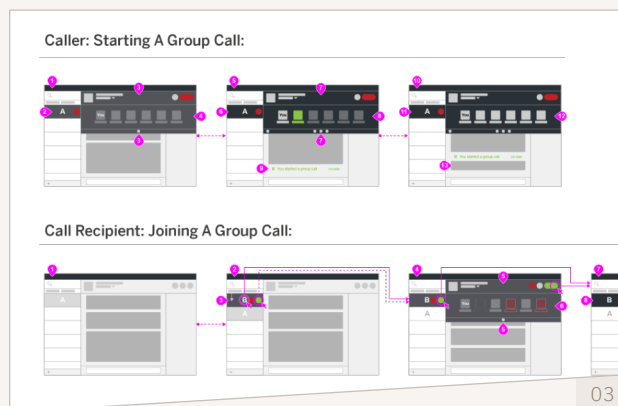
Making work more productive, connected and human centered.



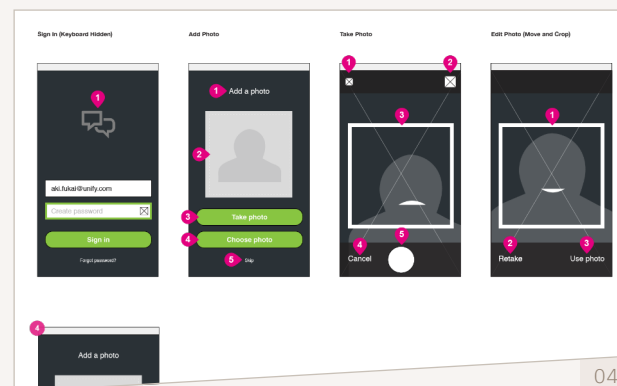
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Project's story: Unify – formerly Siemens Enterprise Communications – in **close partnership** with frog envisioned and defined workforce communication with the **end-user at it's core** to build a **single platform** that works across **multiple devices**.

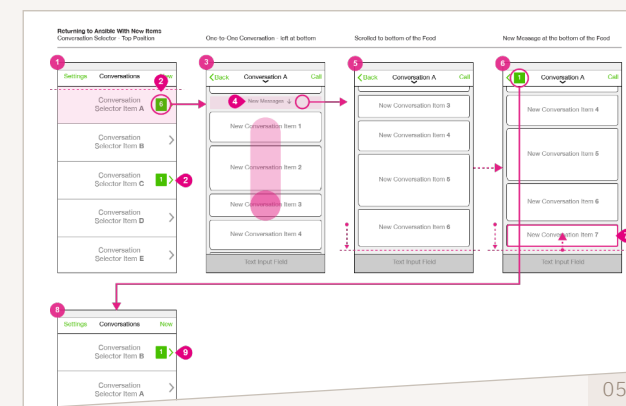
I helped designing and specifying **overarching concepts, user flows, detailed interactions** and **UI components** throughout **web and mobile** for a broad range of features e.g. conferencing, (group) voice/video calls, textual conversations, notifications, **first use** etc. in collaboration with frog's designers and Unify's product owners.



03



04



05

Screens

- 01 Previous page: Multi-device strategy
- 02 iOS and iPhone: UI structure
- 03 Desktop/Web: Ad hoc group call flows

- 04 iOS and iPhone: First use flow
- 05 iOS and iPhone: Read and unread flows

Role: Senior Interaction Designer
Agency: frog design

O2 Relaunch.

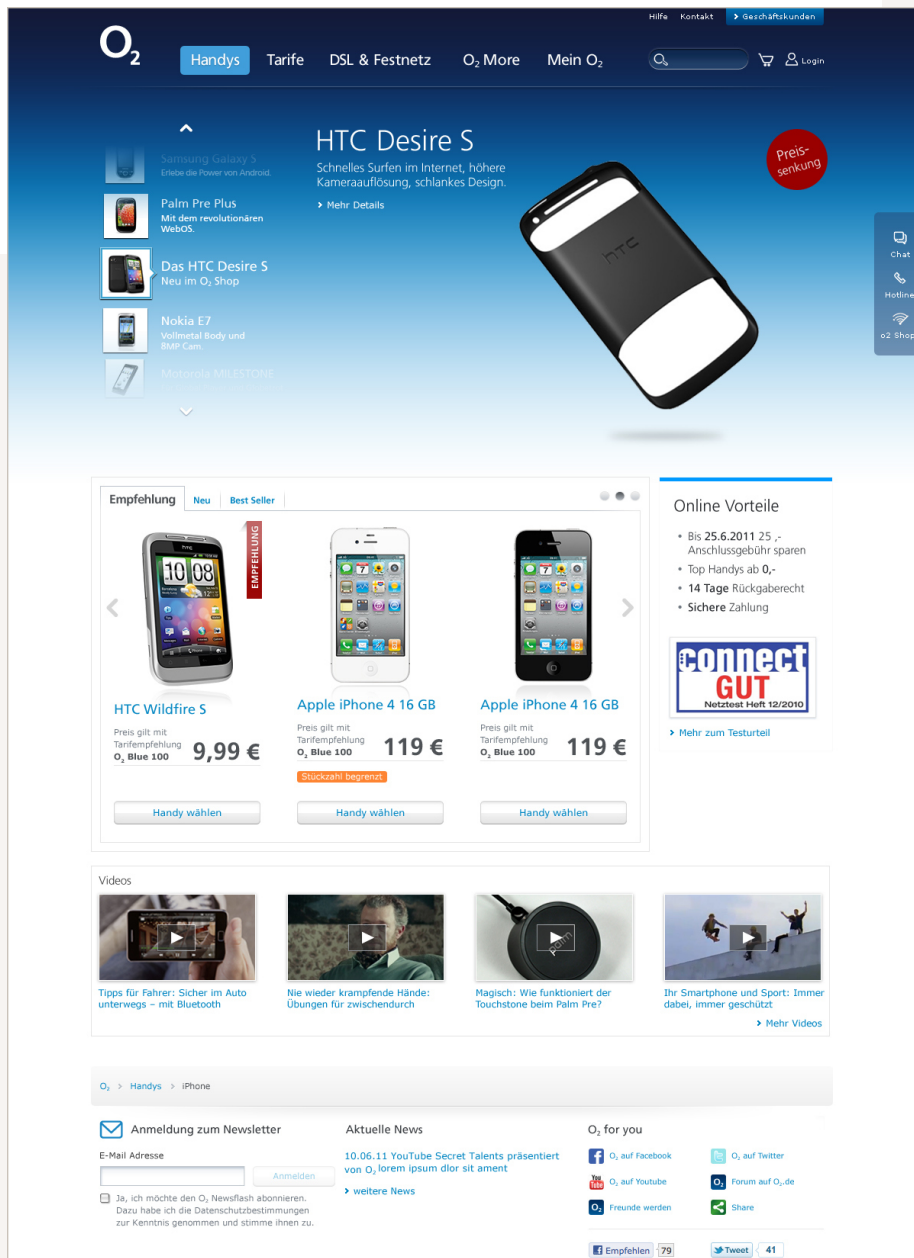
- **Created** the design to win this challenging account
- **Lead** art directors and designers
- **Consulted** on IA and UX
- **Simplified** complex tariff/device shopping flows
- **Designed** a unified and modular teaser concept
- **Optimized** for Tablet/touch
- **Aligned** to the brand
- **Documented** the UX in a style guide

What: Web Portal, eCommerce Platform

Role: Senior Art Director, Design & Concept Lead

Duration: 5 months contract

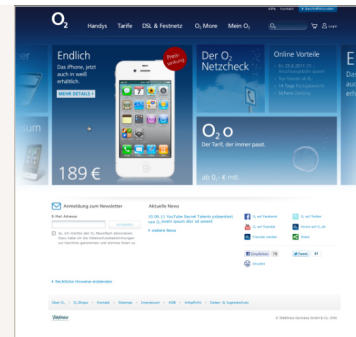




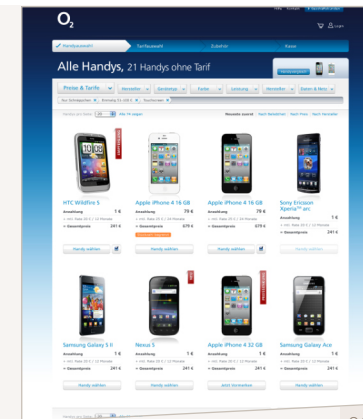
01

02 Relaunch. The consumer portal and its e-commerce flows newly conceived and designed from ground up.

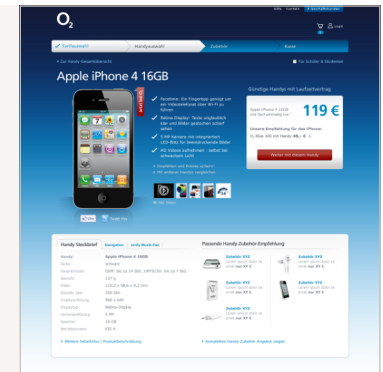
o2.de



02



03



04

Project's story: Starting with conceptual heavy lifting from **shopping flows** via phones and via tariffs, **realignment of the brand** to reworking the different portal sections we talked regularly to our stakeholders in Munich to return with even more tasks on our list.

Visualizing the new concepts from the **epicenter** – the shopping flows enabled us to advance in a **fast and efficient pace**.

The **modular teaser concept** and the capability to **integrate campaigns** seamlessly at its core allowed for a flexible and vibrant portal. Finally I put it all together in a comprehensive style guide as a living and open document.

Screens

- 01 Phone landing page with panorama teaser
- 02 Home with modular teaser
- 03 Mobile phone shop catalogue
- 04 Mobile phone detail page

Role: Senior Art Direction, Design Lead

Agency: Razorfish

Duration: 5 months contract

O2 Brand Design Guidelines. Putting it all together – flexible, modular, scalable and shaped to live the brand values.

Brand Style Guide

- | | |
|---------------------|--------------------|
| 1-4 Sections | 10 Grid |
| 5-8 Type, color, UI | 11 Dimensioning |
| 09 Flexible headers | 12 Modular teasers |



Clients & Agencies

Elbchaussee 15
22765 Hamburg, Germany
USt-IdNr. DE229552221

+49 172 431 15 00
aki@fukai.ch
<https://fukai.ch>

Mobility and availability	Nationality	Swiss citizen		
	Location and time zones	Hamburg, Berlin, Zurich (hybrid) · EST to GST (remote)		
References	Clients I have worked with	academics (Die Zeit, Forschung & Lehre) Audi Beiersdorf (Eucerin) collectAI (Liquid Labs/Otto Group) CTS Eventim Daimler/Mercedes-Benz enfore AG	Henkel (PlasticPlan Venture) Immonet (Axel Springer) JobRad (whatever.works Venture) Liebeskind Berlin Netbreeze (acquired by Microsoft) receivee Rossmann	SAP SE Swiss Federal Railways SBB Sony Deutschland Telefónica Germany (o2) Unify (formerly Siemens Enterprise Comm.)
	Agencies I have worked with	D-LABS DDD Design Experience One EYELABEL Digital Communication Freiland Netzlösungen frog design Häberlein & Maurer Interone	MVPF Technologies Neue Digitale/Razorfish Nolte & Lauth precious design studio Sturm und Drang, Innovation Insights superReal (now Dept) Tempodome (SinnerSchrader Studios leadership)	
Studies		University of Applied Sciences, Department of Design HAW Hamburg Major field of study: Design conception for digital media, advertising (print), corporate design. Furthermore Bauhaus-inspired design studies in typography, photography: b&w (darkroom). drawing, color and form.		
Languages	German English French Japanese & isiZulu	Native tongue Full professional proficiency in speaking and writing Intermediate level (B1) Beginner level		